

Comments for Planning Application DM2025/01591

Application Summary

Application Number: DM2025/01591

Address: Ambulance Station Dorset Road Belmont SM2 6JH

Proposal: Change of use from Sui Generis (Ambulance Station) to mixed use Classes F1 (Places of Worship) and F2 (Community Hub) involving the erection of a part one, part two storey front and side extension, increase in height to part of building and provision of cycle and refuse stores.

Case Officer: Polly Davidson

Customer Details

Name: Mrs Aruna GUPTA

Address: 10 Cumnor Road Sutton SM2 5DW

Comment Details

Commenter Type:

Stance: Customer objects to the Planning Application

Comment Reasons:

Comment: I wish to raise a objection to the proposed planning application on the following grounds while respecting the communities to have dedicated spaces for worship.

The National Planning Policy Framework (December 2024) states that development should support social interaction, promote healthy communities, and avoid harming community cohesion (see paragraph 96 and related guidance). These principles are highly relevant in this case, and the current proposal risks undermining them rather than supporting them.

There are already several established and operational mosques within the borough. When considered alongside available census and demographic information, the level of provision appears disproportionately high in comparison to the size of the local relevant community. In contrast, other faith groups of similar size do not have equivalent dedicated places of worship. Approving further provision for one group therefore raises concerns about fairness, balanced provision of facilities, and equitable treatment across different faith communities. A thorough review of local demographic data and existing places of worship should be undertaken before any further decisions are made.

National policy discussions have increasingly emphasised the importance of integration. The Casey Review highlighted risks such as segregation, residential clustering, and the development of "parallel lives" in some areas. Large or concentrated single-faith facilities can, in some circumstances, become focal points that encourage this kind of clustering over time.

In a borough that is already experiencing demographic change and pressure on local infrastructure, approving an additional large faith facility risks reinforcing separation rather than strengthening inclusive cohesion. This would run counter to the objectives set out in the National Planning Policy Framework for creating integrated, inclusive communities.